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TYPES OF CYBER ATTACKS

Malware is a type of software designed through which the criminals gain illegal access to software and cause damage. Various types of cyber-attacks and their functions are given in**Table 17.2.**

Table 17.2 – Cyber Attacks and Functions

S.No.	Cyber Attack	Function
1.	Virus	A virus is a small piece of computer code that can repeat itself and spreads from one computer to another by attaching itself to another computer file. One of the most common virus is **Trojan**. A Trojan virus is a program that appears to perform one function (for example, virus removal) but actually performs malicious activity when executed.
2.	Worms	Worms are self- repeating and do not require a computer program to attach themselves. Worms continually look for vulnerabilities and report back to the author of the worm when weaknesses are discovered.
3.	Spyware	Spyware can be installed on the computer automatically when the attachments are open, by clicking on links or by downloading infected software.
4.	Ransomware	Ransomware is a type of malicious program that demands payment after launching a cyber-attack on a computer system. This type of malware has become increasingly popular among criminals and costs the organizations millions each year.

Cyber Security Threats

In recent years, most of the individuals and enterprises are facing problems due to the weaknesses inherent in security systems and compromised organizational infrastructures. Different types of Cyber Security Threats are categorized as below:

Social engineering

A misuse of an individual's weakness, achieved by making them to click malicious links, or by physically accessing the computer through tricks. Phishing and pharming are examples of social engineering.

Phishing

Phishing is a type of computer crime used to attack, steal user data, including login name, password and credit card numbers. It occurs when an attacker targets a victim into opening an e-mailor an instant text message. The attacker uses phishing to distribute malicious links or attachments that can perform a variety of functions, including the extraction of sensitive login credentials from victims.